Tamil Nadu
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Tamil Nadu's 1100 kms coastline turning into boon for Water Sports Enthusiasts











Water Sports in Tamil Nadu

The Tamil Nadu coast has emerged as a water sports hub with activities like wave surfing, scuba diving, sailing, kayaking and many more on offer for professionals as well as amateurs.

At nearly 1,100 kilometres, Tamil Nadu has the second longest coastline of any Indian state. This magnificent coastline has been blessed with certain conditions which make it uniquely suited for a variety of water sports. The northern parts of the Tamil Nadu coast have really good waves, making them an excellent location for wave surfing. On the other hand, the southern part of the coastline has stronger winds and is more suitable for wind-based water sports.

All in all, there is a lot of opportunity for tourism based on water sports as well as recreational water activities all along the Tamil Nadu coast. And not just the coast, the lakes and other waterbodies of Tamil Nadu also have immense water sports potential. TTDC's boat houses offer joy rides — like boating, jet ski, banana boat, etc — in a number of locations, including lakes and backwaters.

A few destinations along the coast have emerged as major centres for water sports in Tamil Nadu.

Kovalam

The fishing village of Kovalam (also known as Covelong) lies about 40 kilometres from Chennai and is now India's foremost surfing destination. The big waves here make it eminently suitable for wave surfing. There is a surfing school here where you can learn how to surf. Apart from surfing, visitors can also try boat rides, snorkelling, kayaking and stand-up paddling at Kovalam.

Kovalam is also the venue for surfing competitions as well as an annual surfing festival. Post pandemic, in our current year the festival includes other recreational activities too, and has been renamed Covelong Classic: Surf, Music and Fitness Festival.

In September 2021, Kovalam Beach became the first beach in Tamil Nadu to be awarded the prestigious Blue Flag certification by the Denmark-based Foundation for Environment Education (FEE). This eco-level tag is given to well-managed beaches fulfilling globally recognised standards. Several strict criteria have to be fulfilled, including eco-friendly environment, safety services, water quality, and educational and accessibility standards. Unique amenities like safe swimming zone, amphibious wheelchair and purified drinking water kiosk helped Kovalam bag the certification. Kovalam also boasts an off-grid solar power plant, greywater treatment plant and solid waste management unit.

Rameswaram

Rameswaram has a unique coastline. The beaches face north and south here, as compared to the rest of the east coast where the beaches mostly face east. This makes Rameswaram geographically suited for wind-based sports, since there is always wind blowing on one side with flat water on the other side. Quest Academy here is affiliated with all the relevant international agencies and offers a variety of certified courses for recreational enthusiasts and professionals.

Wind-based water sports you can experience at Rameswaram include sailing, kite surfing and wind surfing. Rameswaram also has really clean waters suitable for scuba diving. The experiences and activities are open to all, and range from recreational joyrides to sports tourism directed at professional sportspersons.

Rameswaram, therefore, draws both curious tourists as well as sportspersons who are interested in learning or practicing a water sport in a new destination. Apart from this, Rameswaram also offers opportunities for snorkelling, kayaking and stand-up paddle boarding.

Thoothukudi (Tuticorin)

Further down the coast from Rameswaram, Thoothukudi is one of the oldest port towns in India and was once called the 'Pearl City' since pearl fishing was an integral part of its economy then. The Gulf of Mannar between Thoothukudi and Rameswaram is India's first marine biosphere reserve. Aqua Outback offers activities like kite surfing, scuba diving, wakeboarding, kayaking, snorkelling, fishing, and stand-up paddle boarding here, besides providing accommodation.

